16 To achieve a perfect fit, the barrel and cap are assembled together and mounted on the mandrel for final shaping and sanding

17 To shape the tip of the cap, it is screwed to the cap body which is then mounted on a threaded mandrel in the chuck. I use a scrap ¼in BSP air line fitting as a mandrel but if need be you could make a mandrel by cutting a thread on a length of acrylic or Ebonite rod. The shaping is done with a sharp spindle gouge or skew chisel

18 Use the clip to check the fit and shape. Here you can see that a little more still needs to be done to achieve a good shape. Once all the components are completed they are hand sanded through the grits to 600 before final polishing

19 Ebonite can be brought to a good shine by buffing with Tripoli followed by white diamond compounds. A light touch is required to avoid overheating the work. Ebonite does not respond well to being overheated so keep speed and pressure low

20 All that remains now is to assemble the components. No pressing or gluing is required, everything simply screws together

21 Your final piece should look something like this ●

16

17

18

19

20

21

HANDY HINTS

1. Ebonite is a hard natural rubber-based material. It is quite abrasive and will blunt tools quickly, so you will probably need to re-sharpen or hone your tools regularly while turning. Tungsten carbide tipped tools are a good option, but will still need to be kept sharp in order to cut cleanly
2. Ebonite will overheat easily so light cuts when turning and slow speeds when drilling and sanding are essential. This will have the added advantage of reducing or avoiding the smell of burning rubber that will occur if the material gets too hot
3. Ebonite does not require an applied finish, it can be brought to a high gloss by polishing. A light touch is required and excessive speed should be avoided so as to avoid the heat generated by the friction of over vigorous polishing. Too much heat can damage the structure of the material near the surface and prevent a high gloss from being achieved. Any of the usual burnishing creams or plastic polishes used with care will produce a top quality finish

WT_290_69_72_PENS_WH_bdVSmbSD.indd 72 28/01/2016 14:57